

Nathan Payne

Senior Platform Product Manager

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Summary

Senior Platform Product Manager, 20+ years in media technology and streaming. Led the SDK and platform layer behind Disney+, Hulu, and ESPN across connected TVs, consoles, and MVPD set-top boxes worldwide. Now focused on AI-augmented product development: building working products with coding agents, designing multi-agent review systems, and developing the governance and measurement practices that make agent-assisted delivery reliable.

Skills

Product & Platform	Platform strategy · Partner ecosystems · Device certification · Roadmap ownership · Program leadership · Release governance · Operational readiness
Analytics & Operations	Snowflake · Looker · Conviva · Sentry · DataDog · Financial modeling · KPI frameworks · Executive reporting · Portfolio dashboards
AI-Augmented Development	Claude Code · Codex · Cursor · CodeRabbit · Anthropic / Claude API · OpenAI API · MCP · LLM application development · Multi-agent code review · AI-assisted PR pipelines · Agent governance · Agent failure-mode diagnosis
Technical	TypeScript · JavaScript · React · Next.js · Astro · Tailwind · Vite · Zod · Firebase · Bash · GitHub Actions · Playwright · Vitest
Domains	Connected-TV streaming · Subscription activation · Media platforms · Sports and entertainment · Partner and vendor management

Experience

Senior Product Manager – Disney Entertainment and ESPN Product & Technology

Native Client Platform (NCP) & ADK · San Francisco · 2021–2026

Product lead for the SDK and platform layer that runs Disney+, Hulu, and ESPN on partner devices. Scope included device certification, partner integrations, platform observability, release engineering, and cross-program alignment with player, engineering, product, and TPM teams.

Led Disney's launch on Amazon's Linux-based Vega OS (Kepler), porting Disney+, Hulu, and ESPN and shipping on schedule with no measurable engagement impact across monthly active Fire TV devices.

Conceived and secured approval for an \$18.1M investment in NCPv3, extending Disney's JavaScript/React application stack across PlayStation, Xbox, Vega OS, MVPD set-top boxes, and smart TVs without requiring a parallel Rust implementation.

Rebuilt partner device intelligence from spreadsheets to structured data, replacing 40+ inconsistent partner questionnaires with a qualification and certification system backed by Snowflake, Partner Portal data, and Looker dashboards. The system now supports AV1/HEVC compliance analysis across Germany and Brazil.

Led On-Device Activation, a multi-partner subscription-activation program that lets subscribers activate Disney+ through their pay-TV operator account instead of re-authenticating in-app. Rolled out across EMEA, LATAM, and APAC operators including Fetch in Australia and Claro in Brazil.

Shipped multiple ADK releases adding live playback, ad playback, advanced video/audio format support, text-to-speech, encrypted audio, and observability improvements, including ADK 4.0 GA in March 2026.

Introduced an AI-powered PR review pipeline for the NCPF App Foundations squad, reducing median PR cycle time from 7.4 days to 4 days and beating the 30% Q2 OKR target.

Owned platform health reporting across Conviva, Sentry, and DataDog, including weekly executive narration of FPS, error rates, Glimpse attribution, and AI PR cycle time.

Senior Technical Project Manager, Lead – Disney Streaming

Living Room Devices Team · San Francisco · 2018–2021

Led front-end engineering teams that built and launched Disney+ across connected devices.

Brought Disney+ from concept to launch across living-room platforms, coordinating engineering, design, product, QA, and release stakeholders.

Led PlayStation prototyping that produced the first-to-launch living-room Disney+ experience.

Rebuilt the Disney+ app for MVPD set-top boxes, recreating the full product experience on constrained operator hardware.

Led Hulu through its PlayStation 5 launch.

Technical Project Manager – MLB Advanced Media / BAMTech Media

Connected Devices Team · San Francisco · 2016–2018

Managed OTT app development for Roku, Chromecast, PlayStation, and Xbox across MLBAM platforms and partners including MLB.com, HBO, Fox Sports, Eurosport, MLS, and NHL. Owned iteration management, development coordination, feature scheduling, QA alignment, and deployment.

Director of Information Technology – AJ+

San Francisco · 2013–2016

Ran Broadcast Engineering, Media Operations, and IT for the launch of a 24/7 digital news operation and the AJ+ social video app—including a live OTT stack (Level 3, Adobe Primetime DRM, Brightcove) and \$335K in annual vendor savings.

Senior Systems Architect – Current TV

San Francisco · 2012–2013

Built ingest, play-out, on-air graphics, and live tweet-moderation systems through Current TV's pivot from user-generated content to prime-time network news, launching three nightly shows within 30 days of acquisition.

Systems Architect / Support Roles – CNN

Washington, DC Bureau · 2002–2012

Conceptualized and led the CNN Magic Wall—the multi-touch platform used on-air for real-time and historical news data. Also built the \$3M Election Express mobile video system, 36-camera virtual studios rendering live 3D “holograms” of remote reporters, and owned \$2M project capital budgets.

Education

B.S., Management Information Systems & Decision Sciences

George Mason University · Fairfax, VA · 2002

Certifications

Building and Scaling Subscription Businesses

Stanford Continuing Studies · 2021

Certified Scrum Professional - Product Owner (CSP-PO)

Scrum Alliance · 2019

Principles & Qualities of Genuine Leadership

Turner Professional Development Center · 2012

Projects

Selected Projects – nathanpayne.com/projects →

Five Across – Live Multiplayer Social Bingo Platform — SHIPPED

React · TypeScript · Vite · Firebase · Cloud Functions · Cloudflare Workers · PostHog

fiveacross.app →

Live multiplayer bingo for group trips, born as a phone-first game built for and live-operated during a nine-night Mediterranean cruise—daily themed cards on ship time, offline-first marking, on-device share cards, a choreographed finale. Now generalizing into a multi-edition platform with wildcard event routing and tenant isolation.

Mergepath – Agent Governance Infrastructure — SHIPPED

Bash · Python · GitHub Actions · 1Password · Claude Code · Codex · Cursor

github.com/nathanjohnpayne/mergepath →

Governance framework for AI-assisted software development combining repository standards, automated review workflows, multi-agent validation, and CI-enforced documentation. Deployed across a nine-repository fleet as of August 2026.

Override – Broadway Financial Operating System — SHIPPED

Next.js · TypeScript · Tailwind · Firebase · Recharts · Vitest

overridebroadway.com →

Broadway financial modeling product that turns static deal documents into an interactive capitalization, waterfall, scenario, and investor-return model. Built as an AI coding experiment; shipped as a demonstration but has not run a real capitalization.

Device Source of Truth – Partner Device Intelligence Platform — ARCHIVED

React · TypeScript · Vite · Tailwind · Zod · Firebase · Express · Vitest

device-source-of-truth.web.app →

Device intelligence platform that unified five fragmented partner-data feeds into one registry, with AI-assisted questionnaire extraction and human authority over consequential commits. Public fork uses entirely synthetic data; production data and repository remain private.

Matchline – AI Career CRM — PAUSED

React · TypeScript · Vite · Tailwind · Firebase · Anthropic · OpenAI · Vitest

github.com/nathanjohnpayne/matchline →

A career CRM for a serious job search: it turns work history into structured, reusable evidence, maps that evidence against specific job requirements, and generates applications whose every claim is checked against approved evidence before it can be exported. Paused before launch after extraction accuracy reached 51.3% against an 80% quality bar; the final work repaired a noisy evaluation system rather than improving the product.

Swipe Watch – Content Discovery Prototype — EXPERIMENT

Vanilla JavaScript · Firebase Hosting

swipewatch.web.app →

Swipe-based Disney+/Hulu content-discovery experiment. The prototype inadvertently simulated the recommendation payoff it was meant to test, making reactions to the demo impossible to separate from reactions to the concept. Demoed to Disney's EVP of Product.

Friends & Family Billing – Shared-Bill Coordination — SHIPPED

React · JavaScript · Vite · Firebase · Vitest · Playwright

friends-and-family-billing.web.app →

Shared billing for recurring household costs that shows recipients the arithmetic, tracks settlement, and handles questions without requiring an account. Built for nine people across five households.

Writing

The AI-Augmented PM – nathanpayne.com/blog →